

Project Background

The Borough of Monaca received a \$150,000 federal grant from the United States Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). The grant was part of a pilot program promoting an area-wide planning approach to community brownfield challenges which recognizes that revitalization of the area surrounding brownfield sites is critical to the successful reuse of a specific property. The area-wide brownfields planning approach enhances EPA's core brownfields assistance programs by encouraging continued meaningful involvement in a locally-driven clean-up and redevelopment planning processes for the future. Each reuse vision was generated through the contributions of the community and community leaders over the course of the project.

What are Brownfields?

The EPA defines brownfields as real property, the expansion, redevelopment, or reuse of which may be complicated by the presence or potential presence of a hazardous substance, pollutant, or contaminant. Cleaning up and reinvesting in these properties protects the environment, reduces blight, and takes development pressures off greenspaces and working lands.



Summary of Potential Brownfields Parcels within the Targeted Reuse Areas

Community	Potential Brownfields Sites	Total Parcel Acreage
Borough of Midland	12	485.25
Borough of Monaca	14	128.24
City of Aliquippa	8	58.49
Borough of Coraopolis	24	70.79

Project funded by a grant from the United States Environmental Protection Agency



OHIO RIVER

AREA-WIDE BROWNFIELDS PLANNING PROJECT

Multiple Communities - One River



Project Overview

The Ohio River Area-Wide Brownfields Planning Project is a community-led effort to promote the clean-up and redevelopment of 40-miles of former industrial lands along the Ohio River in Allegheny and Beaver Counties, Pennsylvania to promote smart growth development practices and to improve the health of the Ohio River ecosystem.



The Borough of Monaca along with its community partners, the City of Aliquippa, the Borough of Coraopolis, the Borough of Midland, and the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) have joined together to undertake a grass-roots effort to re-think the future of our communities as a way to overcome the loss of a major portion of our manufacturing/industrial base and the post-industrial brownfields legacy that remains from that loss. The goal of the project is the development of an area-wide plan for each community's brownfields area, with an emphasis on the Ohio Riverfront, that will inform environmental clean-up activities and subsequent redevelopment and economic investment.



Proposed portion of the 'Green Corridor' with the Ohio River Trail 'Sharrow' and Stormwater Management



Monaca Reuse Concept Plan



Proposed Redesign for 17th Street / PA Route 51 with Innovative Stormwater Management



A Portion of Midland's 'Green Corridor' Reuse Concept Plan

MONACA - Focusing on a large-scale re-visioning of the former Colonial Steel Complex, an entirely new riverfront neighborhood has been conceived by the community which provides improvements to existing industrial activities while allowing for the riverfront to be redeveloped as a mixed-use retail, housing and regional park. Implementing strategic infrastructure improvements along 17th Avenue and extending the existing street-grid pattern and the proposed Ohio River Trail into the area will provide critical multi-modal access, an element necessary to supporting private reinvestment.

MIDLAND - Through the remediation of an abandoned rail corridor and several adjacent post-industrial parcels, a new "green corridor" can be constructed and act as model complete-street serving all modes of travel from trucks accessing the steel mills, to automobiles serving new mixed-use infill development along Midland Avenue and bicyclists and pedestrians utilizing the Ohio River Trail. Strategic soft engineered infrastructure located at street-end parklets can serve as bio-filters to cleanse and retain stormwater before it enters the Ohio River and provide neighborhood open space amenities.



Aliquippa Reuse Concept Plan



Logstown Run Restoration with Park Amenities

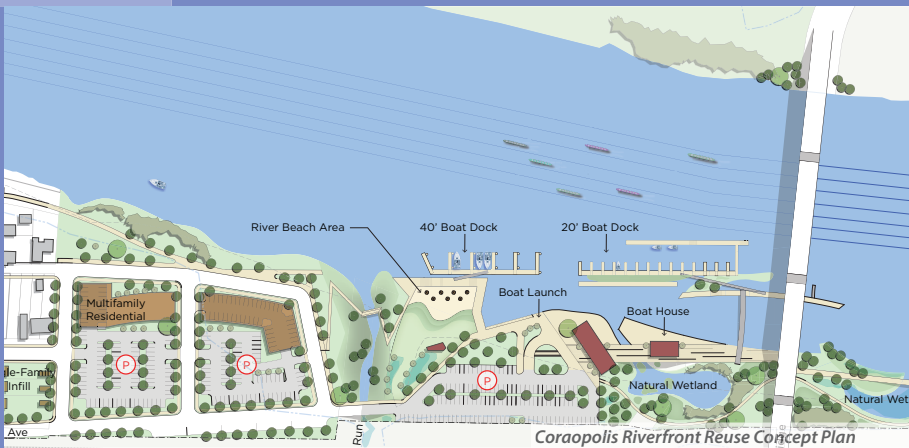
ALIQUIPPA - Re-industrialization for 21st century commerce is already underway within the confines of the original J&L Steel Mill, yet the community desires to be re-connected to the river after 100 years of separation. Restoring Logstown Run as it flows into the Ohio River, improving vehicular circulation and creating a new riverfront park and special-events venue will serve local residents and enhance the economic viability of parcels targeted for industrial redevelopment.



Aliquippa's Riverfront Festival Space and 'Steel Street Stage' Event Space



Coraopolis Multi-Modal Transit Center and Town Square



Coraopolis Riverfront Reuse Concept Plan

CORAOPOLIS - Building upon the Borough's strategic regional location and the gateway to the Ohio River's tranquil back-channel, its riverfront and downtown brownfields sites are ripe for redevelopment. Major regional economic generators such as Robert Morris University, the Pittsburgh International Airport, large-scale industrial facilities on Neville Island and the nexus of the Ohio River and the Montour Trails are creating demand for new multi-family residential dwellings and river-oriented recreational facilities that can serve key catalytic development for the revival this great small town.